

GUARDIANSHIP OF NINA & RAIDEN DECHENE

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033519

Disclosure Re: guardianship cases involving Shasta County Health and Human Services Agency-Judge Wood discloses that her step-daughter, Erinn Watts, is the Administrative Branch Director of the Health and Human Services Agency. In that position, Judge Wood's step-daughter does not have any involvement in the investigation, management, prosecution or defense of guardianship cases. However, the Court makes this disclosure of an employment relationship between an investigating agency and the Court's first degree relative as required by California Code of Judicial Ethics.

This matter is on calendar for hearing on a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Persons. The Petition was filed by the minors' grandfather and step-grandmother, Arnold and Lisa DeChene. The Court notes this guardianship was filed pursuant to a Children's Services safety plan. Letters of Temporary Guardianship issued on August 11, 2026, and are set to expire today unless further extended.

The mother and father have nominated the proposed guardians, consent to guardianship, and waived notice. Petitioners consent to the guardianship. Proof of service has been filed for the maternal grandmother and paternal grandmother. There is no proof of service of the Notice of Hearing and Petition for the maternal grandfather and insufficient information has been provided to permit the Court to dispense with notice. The maternal grandfather may be served by mail. Prob. Code § 1511(c). Alternatively, the maternal grandfather can sign a consent and waiver of notice (GC-211, section 4), in lieu of being served.

The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed September 1, 2026, which recommends granting the Petition. The Petition indicates the minors are not Indian children. If Petitioners have reason to know that the children are Indian children, they must make further inquiry to learn about the children's Indian heritage. The Confidential Guardian Screening Form (GC-212) for Lisa is incomplete as to item 7. The Confidential Guardian Screening Form (GC-212) for Arnold is incomplete as to items 10 and 17. Each Petitioner is **ORDERED** to complete and file an amended GC-212 to address these missing items.

This matter is continued to **Monday, October 19, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Petition. The Temporary Guardianship is **ORDERED** to remain in effect until the continued hearing date. Petitioners are required to file and serve a new Notice of Hearing for the continued hearing date, along with a copy of the Petition, on the maternal grandfather. In the alternative, if Petitioners cannot serve the maternal grandfather, the Court will require a declaration explaining in detail all efforts of Petitioners to locate and serve him and why he cannot be served, to permit the Court to dispense with notice. **Warning: Failure to properly effect service or provide adequate basis to dispense with service as to the necessary parties will result in denial of the Petition. Notice is preserved. No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**